

TO EVERY HUE

Do not be afraid.
Do not act out of emotion.
Do not attack.
Do not defend.
You are worthy.
You have never needed to prove your worth.
You have a choice.
Choose to continue living.
Choose to raise your families.
Choose not to pass down fear, hatred, lack, or scarcity.
Choose not to tell your children that they are separate from
White people, Hispanic people, Indian people, Asian people,
or anyone else.
Tell them the truth.
We are the same. Different shapes. Different shades.
Different cultures. The same humanity.
Some are builders. We know they will work tirelessly to
construct what others only imagine.
Some are creators.
They carry soul through dance, song, art, food, and expression.
Some preserve knowledge.
Some discover.
Some recreate what already exists.
There is nothing wrong with building upon another's creation
when you honor its origin.
That is where we have lost our way.
People steal land, murder, erase names, rewrite history,
claim what they did not create then call it their own.
Honor the creator and the origin.
Then, create something worthy enough
that someone else will one day honor yours.
The goal is not to fight fire with fire.
Both will burn. The goal is to live.
We have been diminished, our bloodlines have been erased,
our families have been murdered
and our voices have been silenced for too long.
The greatest power we possess is our existence.
To continue loving, creating,
raising our children and remembering who we are.
This is not a war unless you choose to make it one.
If you choose violence,
you surrender your life long before your body leaves this earth.
The moment you devote yourself to destroying another,
you stop living as yourself.
Choose life, love and remembrance.

Let your existence become the answer no hatred can erase.

To every soul living through war,

You are not invisible.

The world has heard your cries,
even when governments have not answered them.

To Palestine.

To Israel.

To Ukraine.

To Sudan.

To South Sudan.

To the Democratic Republic of Congo.

To Myanmar.

To Syria.

To Yemen.

To Lebanon.

To Haiti.

To Ethiopia.

To Somalia.

To Nigeria.

To Mali.

To Burkina Faso.

To Niger.

To Cameroon.

To Mozambique.

To the Central African Republic.

To Afghanistan.

To Kashmir.

To every family living beneath bombs.

To every child learning the sound of drones
before the sound of laughter.

To every mother searching for food.

To every father searching through rubble.

To every grandmother keeping generations together.

To every refugee carrying a lifetime in a single bag.

To every person whose home became a battlefield.

I see you.

Your pain is not forgotten.

Your loved ones are not forgotten.

Your children are not forgotten.

Your names are not forgotten.

You remain alive.

Continue loving, creating, singing, dancing, planting,
rebuilding, and continue raising your children with hope
instead of hatred.

The greatest resistance to destruction is life itself.

May every family find safety, every child know peace,
every hostage return home,

every prisoner of war return to their loved ones,
every weapon fall silent,
every leader choose humanity over power,
and every border remember that human life existed before it.
From one soul to another,
You are seen.
You are loved.
You are not alone.
To the United States,
States that are meant to be united,
not separated by hatred.
You are not alone.
No nation is alone.
Bodies of water do not separate us.
They sustain and connect us.
They carry life, memory, movement,
and resources across the Earth.
Acknowledge them.
Stop believing everything you hear.
Stop believing everything you think you see with eyes that have
not yet learned to observe beyond appearances.
We are one.
Honor the land beneath your feet.
Honor the mountains.
Honor the forests.
Honor the rivers.
Honor the oceans.
Honor the walls around you,
built from elements the Earth provides.
Honor the phone you are reading these words on.
Honor the metals.
Honor the minerals.
Honor the energy.
Honor the frequencies.
Honor the books that preserve memory.
Honor the hands that created them.
Honor the creatures beneath the soil.
Honor the beings within the oceans.
Honor the depths of the sea.
Honor the life you have never witnessed.
Your inability to see something
never determined whether it exists.
It existed before you observed it.
It will continue to exist after you look away.
The people you have never met exist.
The lives you have never witnessed exist.
The voices you never heard exist.

WE EXIST.
ALL OF US.
NOT ABOVE ONE ANOTHER.
NOT BENEATH ONE ANOTHER.
TOGETHER.

Donesha Park

